

Research Insights

Seren Kim, Sophie Lee, Feifey Wang
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Insight 1 | Can I Be Myself Here

People hesitate to join communities not because they're unsure of the event's value, but because they're unsure if they can show up as themselves without **forced performance**.

1. **Not forced to perform**

People value spaces where they can show up as themselves, have good conversations, and not feel like they're networking on purpose.

"Being able to show up as herself having a great conversation without having to be an "intentional" version of herself going there to willingly engage in a conversation while speaking about what she likes." (Christine)

"I am past for the show and trying to impress anyone and I don't need to put on ears. I would rather go to a bar probably with people one or two people that I know really well when we can just be ourselves" (Margaret)

"like it's not home and it's not work but it's a place where i can show up fully as myself engaged and be productive you know kind of simulate my mind but then also like it's not a place where i dread going when my god i have thirty o'clock in i have to you know whatever see that guy all seen the people or ah it is just purely a place where I could be fully present and engaged" (Christine)

2. **Forced or contextless small talk, feels fake and draining. It adds mental cost instead of value.**

*"Oh my god they started small talk the moment you step in the elevator and then literally like the person who **is taking me into the building suddenly just randomly starts a conversation** with another person they just met once at whatever conference, just so fake like why?" (Spencer)*

*"I'm okay with small talk that is not related. I'm just not comfortable with the conversation. Now **we have like no topic** or like no it's so personal related and then it's so not necessary and I feel like we can leave that to happy hours." (Spencer)*

*"I need to **prepare for networking based events**, I feel like for networking I'm not good with the person or I'm not good with starting the conversation if I don't know anything about this person." (Spencer)*

Ideation - HMW

- *HMW create spaces where authenticity is the default, not the exception*
- *HMW remove "performance triggers" from our space design?*
- *HMW make it obvious when someone wants to be left alone?*
- *HMW design events that feel like "doing something together" rather than "meeting people"?*
- ***HMW know if someone feels they can "be themselves" in the events?***
- *HMW measures the "authenticity temperature" of our space?*

Ideation - Rough recommendations ideation from insight 1:

Space Rearranging

1. Clearly set out different space environment setup for office&event holding area
Question. Could industrious change their setup?
2. Create isolation space (box like room (phone booth) and w/ do not interrupt sign)
They have Cafeteria and a good view -> become a half-opening space?/ silence area
3. Simple meal gatherings on fixed schedule -> so ppl know when to turn on or off

Event Arranging

1. *A purpose focus and short event (e.g. making stuff. -> the coworker's talent and skill?)
Industrious could open a time slot/ space for people to sign up.*
2. *15 mins short sharing periods that people could sign up and share?*
3. *Topic focus, theme focus. -> reduce the feeling that people had to pretend or prepare. -> Making craft. And even in the refrigerator, or big as a event.*
4. *Similar theme (again) so people will know who might be there the next time (familiar people)
E.g. cultural/ identity related.*
5. *Be themselves - with similar member or community? (Cultural event?/ even sharing something that is related to art/ like a gallery/ or cultural day), which related to some ritual or cultural things.*

Insight 2 | Control over environment and work style

Workers want the flexibility to choose the type of workspace (open or private) that suits their needs, allowing them to balance focus, privacy, and opportunities for collaboration.

1. For focus: fewer eyeballs, fewer interruptions

When people focus, they're trying to reduce social exposure as much as distraction. Open layouts without norms make them feel permanently reachable.

"So many people want different things and they interrupt, either you're you know your daily work gets interrupted either because my boss needs something now, or somebody needs something now, or somebody has a question and I have to help them figure out their job." (Spencer)

"Before we had everybody had their cubicles and that was their work space. Now it's like an open space. We still have kind of like a cubicle thing but it's not as defined. It's more open, you know, which sometimes I don't like because um again the distractions I think it makes people feel free to just walk over to you. You can't like my door doesn't close or you know I'm not sometimes I tell my co-workers if you see me wearing headphones it means my office door is shut so don't disrupt me"(Margaret)

"You sometimes have to help your team members out, but it makes you fall back on the stuff that I have to do." (Margaret)

Here, "control" means being able to **reduce visibility** and **access** without needing to explain.

2. For collaboration: openness and easy access

When collaboration is the goal, visibility and proximity are helpful. Seeing people nearby and reaching them quickly supports shared momentum.

"Aside from the working atmosphere where everyone is working together, which makes me feel like I can't slack off, most people still work face-to-face because it is easier to find people." (Cynthia)

"It would be so much easier to just like go over and be like hey can you like help me with this really quick" (Jasia)

This creates a built-in tension: the same space is expected to support both **deep focus** and **spontaneous collaboration**.

Ideation - HMW

- *HMW design workspaces that support both **deep focus AND spontaneous collaboration** without forcing people to choose one permanently?*
- *HMW reconcile the opposing needs for **visibility (collaboration)** and **invisibility (focus)** in shared workspaces?*
- *HMW create a spectrum of spaces from "completely visible" to "completely private"?*
- *HMW make it easy for people to **move between focus and collaboration modes**?*
- *HMW design **clear, non-verbal signals** that communicate "available" vs. "busy"?*
- *HMW make these signals socially acceptable and widely adopted?*
- *HMW shift the default from "always interruptible" to "intentionally available"?*
- *HMW create a culture where respecting focus time is as valued as being collaborative?*
- *HMW measure if people feel they have adequate control over interruptions?*
- *HMW know if our space successfully supports both focus and collaboration?*

Story:

Industrious as facilitator, even though we couldn't intervene how each company design their spaces, there should be some private space for people to focus on.

->Like how people need to book their time?

->Set your status that you need to focus. -> and show it to others.

1. *Need: Focus & Open.*
2. *Focus*
 - a. *Company: When company didn't support*
 - b. *Personal: wearing earphones, trying to find cubicles in their spaces.*
 - c. *Co-working space support: **How Industrious supports this kind of "focus" need in their open area.*
3. *Recommendation:*
 - a. *Space: Cafeteria/ Kitchen/ other available spaces.*
 - i. *Set an status/ mode that when people in this area, then it means "I'm focused"*

E.g. Margaret's quote. "Sitting in 6-7 people open table."

"Before we had everybody had their cubicles and that was their work space. Now it's like an open space. We still have kind of like a cubicle thing but it's not as defined. It's more open, you know, which sometimes I don't like because um again the distractions I think it makes people feel free to just walk over to you. You can't like my door doesn't close or you know I'm not

sometimes I tell my co-workers if you see me wearing headphones it means my office door is shut so don't disrupt me”(Margaret)

Ideation - Rough recommendations ideation from insight 2:

- 1. Making table spaces with 1. Cubical 2. Open table so people can choose where they want to go everyday*
- 2. A table for talk..... And a table for people who want to stay calm to calm*
- 3. Close space (box like // same as insight 1)*
- 4. Setting out norms like “focus hours” or “no-meeting mornings.”*
- 5. Signs that shows status (also in co-working space)*
-> during the event, a tag shows people's intention / willingness to share, talk or not.
- 6. A space to hide? In the event? -> Breathing area*
-> sleeping room (limit hours)
- 7. Make people feel in control of the space? -> Q. Too hard for industrious to take that?*

Insight 3 | Appreciation, Bonding & The Role of Coworking Spaces

Employee loyalty is not built through corporate hierarchy or formal benefits, but through horizontal peer relationships and authentic appreciation. **When top-down systems fail to provide human warmth, employees turn to bottom-up connections for fulfillment, which creates a fundamental gap that coworking spaces are uniquely positioned to bridge.**

1. Appreciation and Support / 1. Top-Down systems create appreciation deficits / 2. Top-Down alienation vs. Bottom-Up bonding: The loyalty paradox

Traditional corporate structures consistently produce a sense of not being appreciated, where employees feel reduced to functional units rather than valued individuals.

This institutional coldness manifests in several ways:

a. The absence of personal touch

Participants described how companies offer transactional gestures without genuine human connection.

"You know, even if it were just drinks in the office, or hey, let's do a potluck or hey, let's all have this group meeting and talk about something, you know. There's no personal touch to it. I guess the idea is you still have a job. You should be grateful. Show up and do it." (Margaret)

b. What does appreciation actually look like?

When asked what makes people feel valued, responses were simple, which is basic human acknowledgment.

"I think just showing appreciation sometimes even just saying good morning to a person. Hey, how are you doing what's happening in your life." (Margaret)

c. The System vs. The Human

Employees resist top-down systems because they lack **continuity of context and immediate human response**. Submitting issues to a system means uncertain wait times and no connection between past interactions—employees want to "talk to a real person" who can connect the dots and provide pressure for immediate resolution.

"I think that's just been like a value for me like my personal life and I feel like it extends to my working life because like I really like to collaborate with people. I love to be around people. Um I feel like it boosts morale to enjoy the people you're working with and like creating relationships at work. Um and it doesn't sort of only feel like /you're like a work robot." (Jasia)

2. Bonding affects loyalty to their work / Bottom-up bonding drives loyalty

Participants tied their loyalty directly to relationships with coworkers and managers. They stay not just for the work, but for the people they share it with.

a. People > Perks

Loyalty cannot be bought. It emerges from authentic interpersonal connection
"You can pay somebody a lot of money, but you can't buy their loyalty and you can't buy them going above and beyond."(Margaret)

"We have a good team. That's why I'm still there. That's it for me. It's important to work with people that I can get along with." (Margaret)

b. Bonding creates commitment

Participants explicitly tied their willingness to stay to the quality of relationships, not the work itself

"Eating a meal together, feeling more connected and more willing to stay and work, building more loyalty to the team" (Eliana)

"Doesn't really matter in spacing, team and people matters more. The feeling of accomplishment as a team to achieve something." (Eliana)

c. The role of supportive leadership

Workers stay for supportive relationships (teaching, kindness, feeling heard), not company culture or events. When formal culture disappears but interpersonal connection remains, loyalty persists.

"The leadership changed in the company and we have not had events, we have not had things to bring us together. We used to have a company culture. There's not much of that anymore." (Margaret)

"Like my boss is someone who's a teacher. He will take his time and teach you something. You know, if you make a mistake, it's not the end of the world. You learn from it and you move on. So, I think that's the connection. It's the personalities, having personalities that you can work with." (Margaret)

"Well, that's how you get the best out of anybody. You know, people I don't care what anybody says, you know, people want to be heard and they want to feel like they're being appreciated." (Margaret)

d. What might cause people feeling alienated with the company/ How Isolation

Erodes Commitment Isolation in empty offices directly triggers "I might as well go home"— without coworkers present, the workspace offers no advantage over working alone at home.

"If the bonding didn't happened, it would make people feel lonely. Um yeah, I

guess the thing about the working space is that because the floor is so empty and like a lot of the people work remotely it can just get kind of dark and lonely up there.” (Jasia)

“...when it just gets lonely up there in the office. I'm like, 'Okay, well, like I might as well just go home and be by myself.’” (Jasia)

“I feel better in-person because of getting energy from people, but sometimes I don't want to join, having access to everything's and able to use it at anytime not computer only which would be a too serious working space” (Christine)

“If a co-worker isn't there, I'd rather go back home because they aren't able to discuss.” (Eliana)

Together, these accounts show that bonding within teams and with leaders strongly shapes whether people want to stay. Space and amenities matter, but participants consistently framed people and relationships as the core reason they remain committed to their work.

Recommendations - Act as facilitators, not host/organizer

Seren Kim, Sophie Lee, Feifey Wang
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The gap creates an **opportunity** for coworking spaces to bridge
(The need from connecting with people.)
And how do Industrious position themselves as a connection?

Recommendation 1: Peer Driven events & low-stakes conversation starters

1. Encourage Bottom-Up (Worker-Led) Initiatives

a. Act as facilitators, not host/organizer

- i. Provide resources, spaces, and light structure, but let users drive the content and tone of events.

- ii. Frame Industrious as:

“We make it easy for you to gather your people,” rather than “We decide what the community looks like.”

iii. Peer-driven events: Support user-initiated activities based on real interests

- 1. Make it simple for members to propose and host small-scale activities they actually care about (Tea nights, craft sessions, silent reading hours, shared lunches, hobby circles.)
- 2. These formats are low-performance and low-stakes; people don't have to “perform for the company,” which makes it easier to be themselves and creates more authentic connections.

iv. Design low-stakes conversation starters

- 1. Build in tiny, everyday prompts that can spark interaction without **forcing it** (daily tea selection, coffee bean voting) that **enable spontaneous interaction without forced interaction.**

2. Physical but small-scale interaction points
 - a. Whenever there's a **new service or change** (new coffee, layout, amenity), provide a small, neat physical interaction:
 - i. A board or stand with “**Do you like this?**” and simple good / bad / unsure options (stickers, tokens, buttons).
 - ii. Kept visually clean and contained so it still looks professional.
 - b. Keep it **low-effort, anonymous**, and give Industrious quick, real-time signals about how changes are landing.

Make Industrious a place where
“We make it easy for you to gather your people,”
rather than *“We decide what the community looks like.”*

(Industrios to company)

Recommendation 2: Leverage the App

Insight 3 (bottom-up) + Insight 1 (don't want to be forced)

How?

1. Use the app to create more opportunities for employees to engage
2. Use the app as another place for employees to engage

Create a Feedback & Participation System (Let People Speak Back)

Industrious needs an easy way for members to **respond to the space**, not just receive from it.

- b. In-app micro-feedback instead of heavy surveys
 - i. Extend the existing Industrious app from a one-way information channel into a **two-way feedback**, for example:
 1. Quickly rate events (Loved it / Okay / Not for me).
 2. Vote for upcoming events (themes, formats, time slots).

3. Vote on facilities changes (e.g. "Do we want a bookshelf here?", "Which layout do you prefer?").
 - ii. This lets members influence programming **without needing to perform** (no long forms, no big "complaint moments").
- c. Find people with similar interests/ hobbies / in this building e.g. AI in healthcare**
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1. Scope: This recommendation should be "only app specific".
 2. Action: The focus should be on how to "use the app to create more opportunities for employees to give feedback or to interact". Avoid writing recommendations that are too broad, such as "create a feedback and participation system," which could refer to any form of communication.
 3. Current App State: The app is currently underutilized. It primarily functions as a one-way communication channel (Industrious to employee) for viewing food information,. Employees noted that the app does not show pictures of the food, requiring them to go to the cafeteria to confirm what is available, meaning the app is not fully helpful.
 4. New App Functionality: The app should be repurposed for two-way engagement and community building, including features that help employees:
 - Give feedback.
 - Find people to carpool with.
 - Find others with similar professional interests (e.g., AI and healthcare).
 - Showcase "small wins" of employees, such as someone who recently launched a book.
 5. Advanced Consideration: For inspiration on creating engagement, the team could research competitors' apps (e.g., WeWork, Convene, Vers).
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3. Nuanced Space Design

Insight 2 ----- Recommendation 3: Nuanced Space Design

1. Focus on Specificity: Avoid the obvious recommendation to simply create different workspace types (quiet, private, social).

2. Unique Insight: The research should focus on unique insights, such as the finding that while kitchen/dining areas are typically designed as social communal places, a subset of people want to be surrounded by people and noise (like in a coffee shop) but still need to be focused and productive,.

3. Design Opportunity: The recommendation is to design more private or intimate spaces within the dining area that support productivity, rather than focusing solely on collaboration and socializing,. This is a more nuanced and interesting approach than suggesting general environmental control.

Next

1. What's the benefit for Industrious?

1. Storying telling - makes our team

Questions for ourselves:

1. What problem are we solving
2. For whom are we solving these problems
3. Why are we doing this
4. How are we doing this
5. What business goal are we supporting
6. What does success look like for the biz.

Storyline

Curiousc

What will they find compelling?

What questions do they have?

A lingering question becomes a distraction.

Care

What are they motivated by?

What's their why?

Choose

What metrics matter to them?

What are their priorities?

Aligning with strategy reduces friction.

Change

What are the implications?

How can you anticipate them?

Implementation is inevitable. Prep for it.

- Instructor interviewee - Culture ritual
- 1. Engage/not engage, differentiate. -> speak to business painpoint when presenting.
- 2. graphic-> help position where the challenge is .
- 3. How attractive the solution is? Building on what they already have./ guidance for next step.
- 4. Assume that your audience doesn't have any contents.
- 5. Hook->
- 6. (goal, why doing this project, key learning, key recommendation)
- 7. What have you built on, what can we do next?
- 8. Having numbers in the appendix, ready to show
- 9. Visual learner.
- 10. Even no concept, but show what you can think of the next step.
- 11. The more color?? -> voice over what your insights (maybe don't type all)
- 12. 10mins limit. (focus more on the insights > recommendations.)
- 13. Include the goals.

Discussion Board

Rough recommendations ideation from insight 3:

System for report/ giving feedback /arranging events by themselves.

Allowing a system for users to suggest and or give back comments after events, facilities, and or even the operation team. Using a playful(?) way and letting them engage, collecting user feedback as data.

E.g. APP voting for activity? Industrios has their App:

But it is a platform to put company-based, co-working space-based information, but not really a way for people to give feedback. -> Personal touch -> Giving feedback easily? F

E.g. [insight1] People could arrange event by themselves -

Provide pre-event transparency system - **Create standardized event card (categorized - who, what, why and inform dress-code)** (ex: <https://partiful.com/>)

Voting system for upcoming events planning/facilities changing(bookshelf).

Physical but small Interaction

E.g. Whenever there's a new service happening, there could be a board for people to share do they like it or not? (low-effort interaction/anonymous) e.g. sticker-> good /bad.

Q. But Industrious is professional, they probably don't like something mess. maybe thinking how it could be both professional but still welcoming people to interact. Professional & Interactive?

E.g. Interaction board -> provide recognition touchpoint - gratitude board ...?

– inside of the company. / target -> colleagues. Q. How could industrious help company's worker to share their gratitude to their colleagues.

Personal report system - linking to company then to the industrious. (allow people to report things together) **Industrious as 3 party for user&company**

-> insight: Employees resist top-down systems because they lack **continuity of context and immediate human response**.

Supportive leadership outside of company.

Mentorship program? Sharing career/ connecting with others

Question.

Is coworking space a good space to build mentorship? What are the touchpoints? Do people really want to stay at the company and build professional relationships?

2. Counteracting Top-Down Alienation

- a. Provide human-touch service (real people, not systems) for immediate feedback and administrative support
- b. Design spaces as emotional buffer zones where workers can "change the environment" and restore themselves

1. The shift from Before Covid to Post-covid

- a. Before COVID: Company-hosted events
- b. Post-COVID: Self-organized small interactions (tea/coffee, everyday conversations, seasonal rituals) (Expectations impact on people's feeling)

2. Escape from being forced

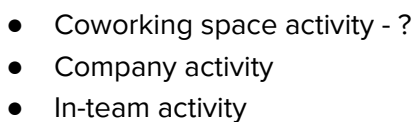
The same people, objects, and setups that signal "company mode" can trigger memories of mandatory, fake-feeling small talk. In contrast, new environments and experiences help people feel restored, refreshed, and like they've temporarily stepped outside the corporate script.

- a. **Getting out of work space to feel restore and refresh**

Leaving the usual work setting or entering a distinct space isn't just a change of environment, it's a reset of emotional expectations. In these moments, people feel fed as humans, not just supported as workers.

"Restored, refreshed. It's like a flower when the sun comes out and you just see the plant, it rises up and it faces the sun. That's the only way I can describe it. I think it's something we as humans need." (Margaret)
"I think it is like, it like feeds your soul. It's like food for the soul"(Margaret)

1. Limited people hired. / From the intercept interview, are there some people not interested?



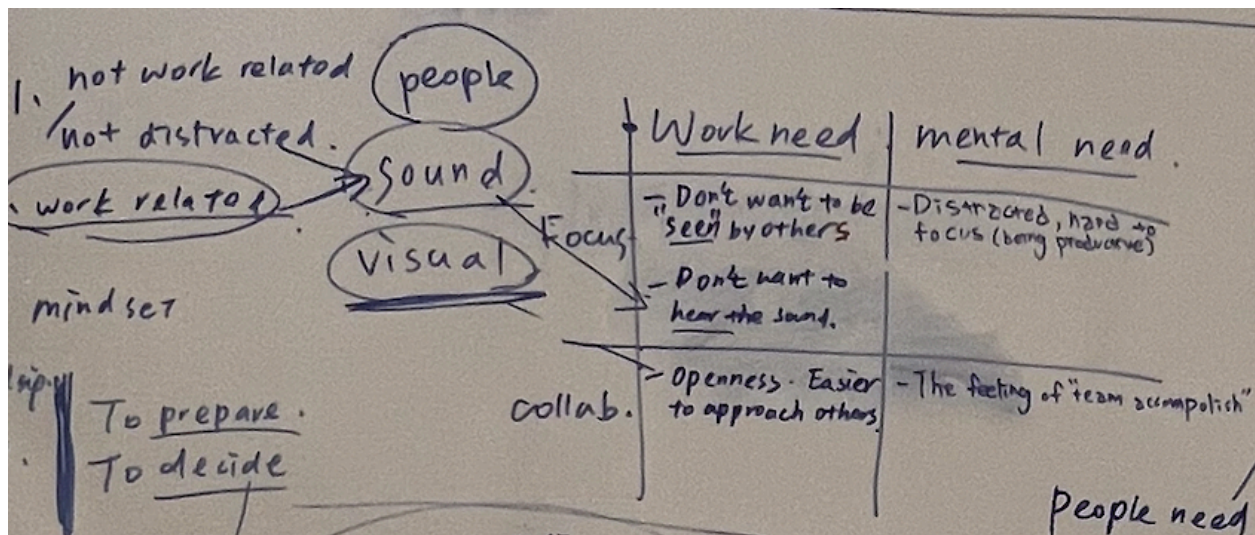
- Jasia: feeling isolated without team/company support(also remote so there are no people there), so go to the company event to meet friends in other group.

- **Physical Space for Bonding and Loyalty:** Even simple shared activities like **eating a meal together** can make employees feel "more connected" and "more willing to stay and work, **building more loyalty to the team**"

Quickly communicate
More data to illustrate.

Boundary? Work and life. ->

Feedback - using this format and develop more :



Note

1. **Decision-making process from value measurement. Mental cost / Knowing "me" is not a cost, knowing a "pretending me" is a cost.**

People evaluate whether an event feels "worth it" before committing, and when that value is unclear—especially whether it fits their personal needs for connection or learning—they hesitate or opt out because the uncertainty makes the commitment feel risky and not worth their limited time and energy.

The risk isn't wasted time, but the mental cost with no guaranteed payoff.

Stage	Info checking	Value measurement	Decide to go
Needs	Know about every information.	1. What are the topics - related to themselves. 2. Who are the	

		people there? 3. Is there free food? - what I can take and go?	
Behavior	Looking at the information		

- b. Topic and theme.
- c. People
- d. Food

"whenever there's like networking always like researching whoever is going there and also like what's the topic for that networking what's the purpose for it and then also like what's the dress code that's the most importantly" - Spencer

Event that need to talk with strangers (forced in interact) - less interested in the event type/ she's more interested in event that is more playful, handcrafting, and performance to watch - Eliana

1. Your company may know data, but they don't have synthesis.
2. Knowing why, why is that important?
3. So what does it mean?
4. E.g. use case./ biggest challenge/
5. For different group, what are there unique point. -> graphic.
6. How can they signal the appreciation/
7. E.g. if we have "Belonging" -where belonging come from? What causes belonging?

-> Feedback : 1, 3 combine,

-> 2 : the next step of taking it further into recommendations will be where you guys like what you're thinking about in a transparency wise, like how they're communicating the event. So I think, like they, for example, a recommendation might be, like, specifically to Brenda, like, when you send out the invite, make these things clear, you know. Like, try to quickly communicate this, what people get out of it or something.

-> How do they use our information...? (industrious)

-> phase, the different phases of The decision process, and then different and then the different groups. **Using graphics!!!!**

-> 1번 : separate different needs

Next week

1. Think specifically what would look like for the Industrious, to take our suggestion.
How could we actually do it.
2. Skeleton for presentation.